

E213: The KRONOS Discovery Phonostage - A New Benchmark

04-29-2025 | By the AudioAnalyst Issue 138



Today will feature the last episode covering my four-day visit to GTT Audio in Long Valley, NJ, two weeks ago, and will focus on one of the most significant, engaging, and important analog products I've ever had the pleasure of experiencing, the KRONOS Discovery Phonostage.

I will apologize now for the lengthy conversation between Bill Parish, principal of GTT Audio & Video, and me as we discussed this seminal, game-changing, phonostage, which, in my five decades of experience in and around this industry, establishes a new benchmark, and by some margin. This phonostage is the epitome of the expression, *sui generis*, a term of Latin origin that means "of its own kind." Anything *sui generis* stands as its own thing; by definition, there is nothing else like it. This is a fitting term to describe the performance of this new, flagship phono preamplifier from the mind of Louis Desjardins and KRONOS...



KRONOS Discovery Phonostage Editorial Transcript & Listening Impressions

A New Benchmark in Analog Playback

The KRONOS Discovery Phonostage was presented not merely as another ultra high-end phono stage, but as a fundamentally different approach to analogue playback.

Throughout the listening session, the reviewer repeatedly described the Discovery as a "true benchmark

product,” “completely sui generis,” and “one of the most significant analogue components in recent years.”
components in recent years.”

Rather than focusing on traditional audiophile spectacle, KRONOS appears to pursue a deeper objective: mechanical silence, signal purity, harmonic integrity, and natural musical flow. Rather than focusing on traditional audiophile spectacle, KRONOS appears to pursue a deeper objective: mechanical silence, signal purity, harmonic integrity, and natural musical flow.

A Sense of Musical Presence

One of the most striking aspects of the Discovery Phonostage was not a particular frequency range or exaggerated sonic effect, but the sensation that music simply existed naturally in the room.

The reviewer emphasized extraordinarily low noise floor, exceptional low-level detail retrieval, effortless microdynamic expression, and natural decay and spatial continuity.

Silence as a Design Principle

A recurring theme throughout the review was the idea of silence — not merely reducing background noise, but removing electronic signature and mechanical haze from the listening experience.

The Discovery was described as lifting a veil from the recording itself, allowing a uniquely immersive and emotionally convincing presentation.

Dynamics Without Artificial Emphasis

The Discovery did not rely on exaggerated impact or hyper-detailed presentation to create excitement.

Instead, dynamics were portrayed as unrestricted, fluid, effortless, and natural. Large orchestral swings and small transient shifts alike emerged without strain or compression.

Harmonic Density & Tonal Realism

Particular attention was given to the Discovery’s ability to combine tonal density, speed, transparency, and harmonic richness.

Many highly resolving phono stages can sound lean or clinical in pursuit of detail. The KRONOS maintained body, warmth, and tonal saturation while preserving openness and precision.

Beyond Traditional Hi-Fi

The reviewer suggested that the Discovery reconstructs the musical event itself, rather than merely reproducing recorded sound.

Its focus is not spectacular audiophile effects, but emotional realism, spatial authenticity, musical continuity,

and natural timing and decay.

Closing Thoughts

By the conclusion of the session, the KRONOS Discovery Phonostage was described as “a new benchmark in analogue playback.”

Rather than sounding like equipment, the Discovery Phonostage was praised for allowing music to emerge with an uncommon sense of ease, coherence, and authenticity.

“Rather than sounding like equipment, the Discovery Phonostage allows music to emerge with extraordinary ease, coherence, and authenticity.”